

How To Build & Deploy a Static Website

Quick Reference Guide · ThePrayingDoctor Ministry

8 Phases · ~4-8 hours total · ~\$10-15/year · Everything else is FREE

- **Decide what your website does** — Define purpose, audience, and content before writing any code
- **Get Claude Code** — AI coding assistant that writes and edits your website files (inside VS Code)
- **Get VS Code** — Free text editor where your project files live
- **Go to Namecheap.com** — Purchase your domain name (e.g., yourdomain.com)
- **Search and buy** — Choose .com for best trust and recognition
- **Enable auto-renew** — So you never accidentally lose your domain
- **Go to zoho.com/mail** — Free professional email tied to your domain (contact@yourdomain.com)
- **Add your domain** — Follow Zoho's setup wizard
- **Add MX Records in Namecheap** — Tells the internet to route emails to Zoho
- **Download Zoho Mail app** — Access your professional email from your phone
Note: Email forwarding requires a paid Zoho plan (~\$1-4/month)
- **Work with Claude Code in VS Code** — Describe what you want — Claude writes the code
- **index.html** — The main page structure (skeleton)
- **css/styles.css** — All the visual styling and colors
- **js/app.js** — All the interactive features and behavior
- **Test locally** — Open index.html in your browser to preview before publishing
- **Add password protection** — Script in <head> of index.html — hides body until correct password
- **Create account at github.com** — Stores your code history and enables auto-deploy
- **Create a new repository** — Name it after your project

Run these commands in VS Code terminal (one-time setup):

```
git init
git config --global user.email "you@example.com"
git config --global user.name "Your Name"
git remote add origin https://github.com/USERNAME/REPO-NAME.git
git branch -M main
git add .
git commit -m "Initial commit"
git push -u origin main
```

- **Future updates** — Just 3 commands: git add . | git commit -m "msg" | git push
- **Create account at netlify.com** — Free hosting for static websites
- **First deploy** — Drag your project folder onto the Netlify "Drag to deploy" area
- **Link GitHub repository** — Deploy Settings | Link repository | select your GitHub repo
- **Auto-deploy is now ON** — Every git push automatically updates your live website
- **Go to Namecheap | Advanced DNS** — Delete all default records first
- **Add A Record** — Host: @ | Value: 75.2.60.5 | TTL: Automatic
- **Add CNAME Record** — Host: www | Value: yourdomain.com | TTL: Automatic
- **Wait 5-30 minutes** — DNS propagates worldwide — green checks mean it's working
- **Test** — Visit yourdomain.com and www.yourdomain.com in your browser
- **Generate logo with AI** — Use DALL-E, Midjourney, or Adobe Firefly with a detailed prompt
- **Convert PNG to SVG** — Inkscape (free, offline): File | Open PNG | Path | Trace Bitmap | Export SVG
- **Place in images/ folder** — Reference as images/logo.svg in your HTML
- **Footer placement** — Add logo + contact email to site footer

How To Build & Deploy a Website — Quick Reference (continued)

Changes not showing on site Run <code>npm run deploy</code> .	Hard refresh: <code>Ctrl+Shift+F</code> Deploy command: <code>npm run deploy</code> or <code>npm run deploy:prod</code> Push to Github repository: <code>git push</code> Correct URL: <code>https://www.yourdomain.com</code>